China Trip

October 2026

Beijing · Huangshan · Wuzhen · Hangzhou · Macao · Hong Kong
Sun Oct 18 - Sun Nov 1, 2026 · 15 days

The Forbidden City, Beijing - the centrepiece of your first full days in China.

Dates	Base	Hotel (as booked)
Oct 19	Beijing	Hampton by Hilton Beijing Changping (Andrew booked)
Oct 20-22	Beijing	China World Summit Wing, Beijing
Oct 23-24	Huangshan	Oct 23: Holiday Inn Express Huangshan South Gate. Oct 24: overnight on the mountain (booking TBD)
Oct 25	Wuzhen	Crowne Plaza Wuzhen
Oct 26	Hangzhou	Midtown Shangri-La, Hangzhou
Oct 27	Hangzhou (airport)	Holiday Inn Hangzhou Airport Zone - 2 rooms (conf 42630461 / 45439890)
Oct 28	Macao	Four Seasons Macao - 1 night,

		$297.36 confirmed
Oct 29-Nov 1	Hong Kong	Conrad Hong Kong (Andrew booked, from Oct 29)

Prepared Oct 9, 2026 from the family master schedule (Donna Lin, Oct 3) and public visitor information checked the same week. Updated Oct 11: added Oct 19 airport pickup (WYOO1GZNNK); corrected flight numbers/times from your saved confirmations; added Donna's separate arrangements; Oct 24 now a mountain-top night; added Trip preparations section (connectivity, apps, customs); added eSIM pick from Oct 11 esimdb scrape (ESIM.DOG 30 GB/12 d, $10.23 — not yet purchased). Confirmation codes are listed exactly as recorded - re-check them in the airline and hotel apps before departure.

Before you go

Passports and visas - read this first

Mainland China, Macao and Hong Kong have separate entry rules. As of the guidance checked for this document, US passport holders need a visa arranged in advance for mainland China (the tourist L visa; recent guidance describes 10-year multiple-entry visas as common for US citizens, with passport validity of at least six months and a blank page required). Hong Kong is visa-free for US passport holders for short visits, and Macao also admits US passport holders for short stays. Rules change - confirm your specific passports and any existing visas with the Chinese embassy/consulate or an official source before Oct 18, and carry the passport you booked tickets with, since major attractions use real-name, passport-checked entry.

Money and payments

- Set up Alipay and WeChat Pay before you leave the US and link a card that does not charge foreign transaction fees. Small vendors, taxis and ticket mini-programs assume mobile pay.
- Carry some RMB cash in small notes for Huangshan shuttle buses, temple donations and rural stops.
- Hong Kong uses HKD and Macao uses MOP (HKD is widely accepted in Macao). Your Amex Platinum and no-FTF cards are fine in hotels; mobile pay covers the rest.
- Notify your banks of China / Hong Kong / Macao travel dates.

Connectivity

Mainland China blocks Google and all Meta apps. See the full **Trip preparations** section overleaf - the short version: install a travel eSIM and two VPN apps **before** departure (you cannot download them once there), and download offline maps for Beijing, Huangshan, Wuzhen, and Hangzhou in Amap.

Health and comfort

- Bring prescription copies, a small first-aid kit, blister care (Huangshan and the Great Wall are stair-heavy), and any altitude/motion medicine your group uses. Tap water in mainland China is not drunk straight - hotels supply boiled or bottled water.
- Travel insurance that covers medical evacuation and trip interruption is worth it for a 15-day, multi-city family trip.

Trip preparations: connectivity, apps, and customs

The Great Firewall blocks Google, Gmail, YouTube, and all Meta apps on mainland Chinese networks. Set up two independent ways around it **before you fly** - the Play Store and VPN provider websites are blocked once you are there. Hong Kong and Macao have open internet; none of this applies there.

Travel eSIM - the highest-leverage move

- Travel eSIMs (Holafly, Airalo, Nomad, Ubigi, Jetpac, Saily) are sold as international roaming: your data tunnels out through Hong Kong or Singapore, so Google, WhatsApp, and Instagram work with **no VPN at all**.
- Holafly unlimited: 10 days $37.50 / 15 days $51.50 (esim.holafly.com/esim-china). Capped 10 GB plans run about $16-27 (Nomad, Jetpac, and Ubigi near $16-17; Airalo about $26.50; Saily about $27).
- **Cheapest pick, researched Oct 11 on esimdb.com:** ESIM.DOG 30 GB / 12 days at $10.23 — covers all 10 mainland days and routes via Hong Kong, so Google and Meta apps work with no VPN. Runner-up: Stellar 30 GB / 20 days at $10.24 (Hong Kong breakout, free VPN included). Cheapest true 3 GB/day plan: Giga.Tel 3 GB/day / 15 days at $14.25, which also covers Hong Kong and Macao. MobiMatter's 20 GB / 30 days ($13.99) fails the 3 GB/day bar. **Not purchased yet — buy and install before departure.**
- Buy **and** install the eSIM before departure - installing the profile needs open internet. Travel eSIMs are data-only (no +86 number) and skip China's real-name registration entirely.

VPN as backup - install two before departure

- **NordVPN** (obfuscated servers / NordWhisper, about $3-3.49/mo) and **ExpressVPN** (Lightway with automatic obfuscation, about $2.99/mo) are the commonly recommended pair; **Astrill** ($12.50+/mo, no refund) is the long-time reliability pick. Note that 2026 reports on ExpressVPN vary.
- Turn on obfuscation/stealth mode and pre-save servers in Hong Kong, Taiwan, Japan, and Singapore. An April 2026 crackdown knocked out many Shadowsocks/V2Ray relays, so free and DIY options are unreliable now.

Yes, Meta is blocked

Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, Threads, and Messenger are all blocked on mainland networks (WhatsApp since 2017). They work normally on the travel eSIM, over VPN, and in Hong Kong and Macao.

Android app kit - install before you fly

- **Maps:** Amap (English mode, works with a foreign number) is the pick for visitors; Baidu Maps as backup. Google Maps data in China is years stale.
- **Ride-hailing:** DiDi - English interface, foreign numbers and foreign cards accepted.
- **Payments:** Alipay and WeChat Pay - link a no-foreign-transaction-fee card and complete passport verification before the trip. Under about CNY 200 per transaction there is no extra fee; above that expect around 3%.

- **Trains and tickets:** Trip.com (full English, small per-ticket fee) or 12306, the official railway app (face value, English version, passport is the ticket; booking opens 15 days out).
- **AI assistants:** DeepSeek is the best-documented option for foreign visitors; Doubao and Kimi are Chinese-first and signup for foreigners is unverified.
- **Also:** WeChat (messaging, mini-programs for bookings, built-in translator).

Translators with camera OCR

- **Google Translate:** download the offline Chinese pack before the flight. Typed translation and the live camera overlay then work fully on-device; voice mode and photo import need Google servers and will not work without a VPN.
- **Backup:** Microsoft Translator (offline packs plus camera) or Baidu Translate (native app, strong camera OCR, mostly Chinese UI).
- **Pleco** is a fully offline Chinese dictionary; its camera OCR is a paid add-on (about $29.99).

Customs and cultural notes

- **Chopsticks:** never stick them upright in rice; do not point with them; use the serving chopsticks when a dish provides them.
- **Tipping** is not customary - do not tip; it can confuse rather than please.
- **Bargaining** is expected in markets, not in malls or restaurants.
- **Give and receive** business cards, gifts, and money with two hands.
- **Toilets:** carry tissues; squat toilets are still common outside hotels.
- Public smoking and spitting persist - mildly startling, entirely normal. Avoid sensitive political topics with strangers.

Day-by-day itinerary

Date	Plan	Sleep
Sun Oct 18	Depart JFK 10:00 AM - Cathay CX841 to Hong Kong (arr 1:55 PM Oct 19), connect to CX336 to Beijing (arr 6:25 PM). AA conf CUNUXA / Cathay conf AGQTVD.	Plane
Mon Oct 19	Arrive PEK 6:25 PM (CX336, T3). Pre-booked business-car pickup to the hotel - order WYOO1GZNNK (700 pts via mobile banking, 上海盛世大联汽车服务); driver contacts Mr. Lin at 15510111357 after landing. Light dinner, sleep early - jet lag day.	Hampton by Hilton Beijing Changping
Tue Oct 20	Move to China World Summit Wing. Tiananmen Square and Forbidden City (book 7 days ahead, closed Mondays, so Tuesday works). Jingshan Park at closing.	China World Summit Wing
Wed Oct 21	Mutianyu Great Wall day trip (details overleaf). Evening: Peking duck dinner.	China World Summit Wing
Thu Oct 22	Temple of Heaven early, hutong walk and Lama Temple later. Buffer if Forbidden City tickets landed here instead.	China World Summit Wing
Fri Oct 23	Air China CA1551 PEK to Tunxi (Huangshan) 1:05-3:15 PM. Justin+Andrew: UA conf H2GPV5 / Air China NLXSXY, seats 14A/14C. Donna on the same flight (UA MD83EF / Air China PDE5G7). Transfer to South Gate (Tangkou), check in, early night.	Holiday Inn Express Huangshan South Gate (conf 49804652 / 41296616)
Sat Oct 24	Full Huangshan mountain day (cable car up, summit walk). **Overnight on the mountain** - the Oct 24 South Gate rooms were cancelled, and the sunrise is the payoff.	On the mountain (no confirmation in your saved files - make sure it is booked)
Sun Oct 25	Travel to Wuzhen (confirm exact mode - high-speed rail to Tongxiang plus shuttle/taxi is the usual pattern). Afternoon and night in Xizha.	Crowne Plaza Wuzhen
Mon Oct 26	Morning in Wuzhen, then Hangzhou. West Lake at golden hour.	Midtown Shangri-La, Hangzhou - 2 rooms (Amex FHR ZO-AX1064-61022 $177.12 / ZO-AX1063-07696 $176.95)
Tue Oct 27	Lingyin Temple and Feilai Peak in the morning, Longjing tea villages after lunch. Move to	Holiday Inn Hangzhou Airport Zone - 2 rooms (conf 42630461 / 45439890)

	airport hotel for tomorrow's flight.	
Wed Oct 28	Xiamen MF8719 Hangzhou 2:45 PM to Macao 5:30 PM (PNR JSX01J; Justin, Andrew, Donna). Senado Square and Ruins of St Paul's at dusk, Macanese dinner.	Four Seasons Macao (Amex ZO-AX1089-43101, 2 adults, $297.36)
Thu Oct 29	Morning Macao heritage walk, then Hong Kong (ferry or HZMB bus). Check in Conrad Hong Kong. Donna splits off: EVA BR802 Macao to Taipei 1:15-2:55 PM, then Taiwan through Nov 10 (see below).	Conrad Hong Kong (3x 1-night awards, 85k Hilton pts each: conf 3482316537 / 3490690954 / 3485284263)
Fri Oct 30 - Sat Oct 31	Hong Kong: Victoria Peak, Star Ferry, Tsim Sha Tsui / West Kowloon, markets and dim sum. Keep one half-day unplanned.	Conrad Hong Kong
Sun Nov 1	Cathay CX840 Hong Kong 4:35 PM to JFK 7:05 PM (AA SSQSTQ / Cathay B88V3W) - same-day arrival in New York thanks to the date line. **Cathay flagged an operational change on this booking - review the itinerary in the Cathay app before you fly.**	Home

Donna's arrangements differ

Donna (Chunyin Tsai) flies in earlier and stays on after the family trip, with her own bookings:

Date	Donna's plan
Oct 14-15	JFK to Beijing via Seoul: Asiana OZ223 dep JFK 1:30 AM Oct 14, OZ331 arr PEK 9:40 AM Oct 15. Business, ANA award.
Oct 15-22	Own Beijing/Tianjin circuit: Summit Wing Oct 15, 17, 19; Four Seasons Beijing Oct 16; Tianjin Holiday Inn Riverside Oct 18; Crowne Plaza Badaling Oct 20; InterContinental Beichen Oct 21. Rejoins the family at the Summit Wing Oct 20-22.
Oct 23-28	With the family (own CA1551 booking: UA MD83EF / Air China PDE5G7; MF8719 to Macao).
Oct 29	EVA BR802 Macao to Taipei 1:15-2:55 PM (booking BUSA-36010336). Holiday Inn Taoyuan Airport.
Oct 30 - Nov 10	Taiwan, own plans (Nov 1 medical checkup): InterContinental New Taipei Hot Spring Nov 2, Crowne Plaza Tainan Nov 3-7, InterContinental Taichung Nov 8, Shangri-La Taipei Nov 10.
Nov 11	Taipei to JFK: ANA NH854 dep 4:50 PM, Business (conf F7IY75).

Beijing - Oct 19 to 23

Your base for three nights, China World Summit Wing (No. 1 Jianguomenwai Avenue, Chaoyang District, Beijing 100004; phone +86 10-6505-2299; check-in 2:00 PM, check-out 12:00 PM), sits on top of the Guomao metro interchange in the CBD, about 15 minutes by car to Tiananmen. Late October is Beijing's best weather window: dry, clear, daytime roughly 16-19 C (61-66 F) falling to about 5-7 C (41-45 F) at night during your dates, cooling as the week goes on. Dress in layers.

Forbidden City from Jingshan Park - go up Jingshan after you exit the palace's north gate for this exact view.

Forbidden City (Palace Museum)

- **Where:** 4 Jingshan Front Street, Dongcheng District, north of Tiananmen Square. Enter only via the Meridian Gate (south).
- **Hours:** 8:30 AM-5:00 PM in peak season (last entry 4:00 PM); closed Mondays. Your visit days Tue-Thu Oct 20-22 are all open.
- **Tickets:** Around CNY 60 in October (peak season), plus CNY 10 each for the Treasure Gallery and Clock Gallery. Real-name online booking only, released 7 days ahead at 8:00 PM Beijing time and often gone in minutes - set an alarm for Oct 13 US time. Bring the exact passport used to book.
- **How long:** 3-5 hours. Walk the central axis, then detour into the quieter western palaces.
- **Transit:** Metro Line 1 to Tiananmen East/West, then walk through the Tiananmen gate (separate real-name check).

Temple of Heaven, hutongs, Lama Temple

Temple of Heaven park opens early and is at its best before 9 AM. Pair an afternoon hutong walk (Nanluoguxiang is the polished version; the lanes west of the Drum Tower are quieter) with the Lama Temple (Yonghegong) - both are on Metro Line 5. No booking friction like the Forbidden City; go when the group has energy.

Beijing - Great Wall day

Mutianyu in late October - you are timing this for peak autumn colour on the ridges.

Mutianyu Great Wall - Wed Oct 21 (suggested)

- **Distance:** About 73 km northeast of the city, 75-90 minutes by car. Hire a private driver through the hotel or DiDi; leave by 7:00 AM to beat tour buses.
- **Hours:** Roughly 7:30 AM-6:00 PM in season.
- **Costs:** Entry about CNY 45, internal shuttle about CNY 15-20 return, enclosed cable car to Tower 14 about CNY 100 one-way / CNY 140 return. The open chairlift plus toboggan slide down is the fun alternative (same price band; toboggan closes in wet weather) - pick one system, they serve different towers.
- **Route:** Cable car up to Tower 14, walk west toward Tower 20 (the steep, photogenic stretch), then back and down. 2-3 hours on the wall is plenty with stairs.
- **Bring:** Grippy shoes, wind layer (the wall is noticeably colder and windier than the city), water, sunscreen. There is no food worth planning around on the wall itself - eat back in the city.

Eating in Beijing

- **Peking duck:** Book ahead for the Oct 21 evening - Siji Minfu and Quanjude are the classic names; order the duck plus duck-frame soup.
- **Breakfast:** Jianbing (savoury crepe) from a street cart near the hotel, soy milk, youtiao.
- **Snacks and gifts:** Wangfujing is touristy but convenient from Guomao by Metro Line 1.

Huangshan - Oct 23 to 24

Huangshan's granite peaks above the sea of clouds - the view the whole detour is for.

You land mid-afternoon Fri Oct 23 and have Sat Oct 24 on the mountain. Oct 23 night is at the South Gate (Tangkou); Oct 24 you sleep on the mountain itself, which unlocks the sunrise. Huangshan weather turns fast and the summit is 8-10 C colder than the town - this is the one place on the trip where a warm, waterproof layer is non-negotiable.

The mountain day (Sat Oct 24)

- **Scenic area hours:** Roughly 6:00-6:30 AM to 5:30 PM in season; cable cars run similar hours, stopping around 5:00-5:40 PM. Confirm the day's times on the official WeChat mini-program the night before.
- **Tickets:** Scenic entry about CNY 190 in season (valid 3 days), scenic shuttle about CNY 19 each way from Tangkou transfer centre. Yungu (Cloud Valley) cable car about CNY 80 one-way; Yuping (Jade Screen) cable car about CNY 90 one-way; West Sea canyon sightseeing train about CNY 100 one-way.
- **Classic route:** Shuttle to Yungu station, cable car up (Back Mountain - gentler start), walk via Beginning-to-Believe Peak and Beihai to Bright Summit (1,860 m, the second-highest peak), then south to the Guest-Greeting Pine. About 5-6 hours with photo stops, mostly paved steps - thousands of them. Overnight near the summit instead of descending.
- **Sunrise:** You are sleeping on the mountain, so set the alarm - the sea-of-clouds sunrise is the whole point of the overnight. Bright Summit and Refreshing Terrace are the classic viewpoints; check with the hotel which is open.

Practical notes

- Book entry plus cable cars in advance on the official mini-program; holiday queues at Yungu can run over an hour.

- Carry water and snacks up - summit prices are steep and options thin. Trekking poles genuinely help on the descents; buy cheap ones in Tangkou.
- Luggage stays at the South Gate hotel; bring an overnight daypack up the mountain.

Wuzhen and Hangzhou - Oct 25 to 27

Wuzhen Xizha after dark - stay for the evening, this is when the town earns its reputation.

Wuzhen - Sun Oct 25 (Crowne Plaza Wuzhen)

- **Xizha (West Scenic Zone):** Open about 9:00 AM-10:00 PM; entry around CNY 150, combined Xizha plus Dongzha ticket around CNY 190. Rowing boat about CNY 60 per person (shared) or CNY 480 per boat.
- **Do:** Arrive mid-afternoon, wander the lanes and dyeing workshop while it is light, take a boat at dusk, then walk the lit canals after dinner. White Lotus Pagoda and the waterside theatre are the evening landmarks.
- **Dongzha (East):** Opens earlier (about 7:00-7:20 AM) and is the more lived-in, morning-market side. Only add it if you are up early on Oct 26 before leaving.

Hangzhou - Oct 26 to 27

Leifeng Pagoda over West Lake, Hangzhou - aim for this light on Oct 26.

West Lake and Lingyin - Mon Oct 26 to Tue Oct 27

- **West Lake:** Free and always open. Walk or cycle the Su Causeway, take a rowing boat from Zhongshan Park wharf, and be on the east shore for sunset behind Leifeng Pagoda.
- **Lingyin Temple and Feilai Peak** (1 Fayun Lane, Lingyin Road, Xihu District): roughly 7:30 AM-5:30/6:00 PM, last entry about 5:00-5:30 PM; Feilai Peak scenic ticket about CNY 45 plus Lingyin Temple about CNY 30 (around CNY 75 total), booked via the West Lake scenic WeChat channels. Go at opening on Oct 27 - it is a major pilgrimage site and crowds build fast. Dress modestly; no photos inside halls.
- **Longjing tea:** After Lingyin, taxi 15 minutes to Meijiawu or Longjing village for lunch and fresh Dragon Well tea in a farmhouse courtyard.
- **Getting around:** Metro and DiDi both work well; West Lake traffic crawls on weekends, so walk the lake legs.

Macao and Hong Kong - Oct 28 to Nov 1

Ruins of St Paul's, Macao - free, always open, best photographed early or at golden hour.

Macao - Wed Oct 28 (Four Seasons Macao, 1 night)

- **Ruins of St Paul's** (Calcada de Sao Paulo): facade open all day, free; Museum of Sacred Art and Crypt about 9:00 AM-6:00 PM (last entry 5:30 PM). Walk up via Senado Square (free, open 24 hours) and St Dominic's Church - the whole Historic Centre is a UNESCO listing.
- **Also close:** Mount Fortress and Macao Museum right behind the ruins (museum small fee, about MOP 15 per recent guides - confirm on site).
- **Eat:** Portuguese egg tarts (Lord Stow's is the famous name; there is a branch at the Venetian near your hotel), pork chop bun, and a Macanese dinner - African chicken or minchi - in the old town before the Cotai lights.
- **Getting there / onward:** You fly in Oct 28 (2:40-4:00 PM). For Hong Kong on Oct 29, choose between the fast ferry and the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge bus - ferry lands you on Hong Kong Island near the Conrad; the bridge bus is cheaper and scenic. Decide as a group the night before.

Hong Kong - Oct 29 to Nov 1

Hong Kong from Victoria Peak at night - your Oct 30 or 31 evening, weather permitting.

Conrad Hong Kong base - Thu Oct 29 to Sun Nov 1

- **Victoria Peak:** Peak Tram (33 Garden Road, Central) runs about 7:00 AM-midnight; Sky Terrace 428 roughly 10:00 AM-10:00/11:00 PM (earlier on weekends). Buy tram-plus-terrace tickets online to skip the queue, and pick the clearest evening of Oct 30-31 - haze decides the view more than anything.
- **Classic loop:** Star Ferry from Tsim Sha Tsui, tram up in late afternoon, Lugard Road flat walk (about 3.5 km, free, the locals' viewpoint) at sunset, dinner in SoHo or at the Peak.
- **Fill the other day with:** West Kowloon and M+ / Hong Kong Palace Museum, Temple Street or Ladies' Market, and a proper dim sum lunch (book ahead on weekends).
- **Departure Sun Nov 1:** Cathay Pacific 3:35 PM departure - Airport Express from Hong Kong Station gets you there in about 24 minutes; leave the Conrad by 12:30 PM with bags. In-town check-in at Hong Kong Station is an option if your airline supports it that day.

Packing list

Late-October China on this route spans roughly 5 C Beijing nights to 25 C-plus Macao afternoons. Pack in layers you can peel as you travel south, in one checked bag plus a daypack per person. Check off as you pack.

Clothing

- Merino or synthetic base layers (2-3 tops)
- Long-sleeve shirts / light knits (3-4)
- T-shirts for Hangzhou/Macao/Hong Kong (3)
- Mid-weight jacket (water-resistant)
- Warm insulated layer for Huangshan + Great Wall
- Long trousers (2), one nicer pair for hotel dinners
- Comfortable dress or collared shirt for Four Seasons / Conrad dinners (optional)
- Sleepwear, underwear, socks (merino for hiking days)
- Light scarf, thin gloves, warm hat (mountain days)
- Sunglasses

Footwear

- Broken-in walking shoes (primary)
- Grippy hiking shoes for Huangshan / Great Wall
- Compact sandals or hotel shoes

Weather and day kit

- Packable rain shell or compact umbrella
- Daypack (20 L) with water bottle
- Trekking poles (or buy cheap in Tangkou)
- Sunscreen, lip balm, hand cream (Beijing is dry)
- Blister kit, pain relief, any personal meds

Documents and money

- Passport (the one used for bookings) + phone photos of it
- Visa paperwork / prior visa pages if applicable
- Flight and hotel confirmations saved offline
- Cards with no foreign transaction fees + small RMB cash
- Travel insurance details offline

Tech

- Phone with eSIM/roaming set up before departure
- VPN installed and tested at home
- China plug adapter (Type A/C/I - hotels often have universal sockets)
- Power bank (must be in carry-on; China flights are strict)
- Charging cables, earbuds for flights
- Offline maps and translation app downloaded

Family and comfort

- Shared snack bag for train/transfer days
- Laundry bag - use hotel laundry mid-trip (Hangzhou)
- Small gifts from home if visiting family friends
- Entertainment loaded for the 15-hour flights
- Neck pillow, compression socks for long-hauls

Practical tips, etiquette, and open decisions

Getting around in mainland China

- **DiDi** is the ride-hailing default; hotels will write destination names in Chinese characters for drivers - screenshot them.
- **Metro** in Beijing and Hangzhou is cheap, signed in English, and paid by Alipay/WeChat transit QR codes.
- **Real-name everything:** Trains, flights and major attractions tie tickets to passports. Keep passports on you (securely) every sightseeing day, not in the hotel safe.

Etiquette worth knowing

- Temples: modest dress, hats off inside halls, no photography where signed, walk clockwise where locals do.
- Tea and dining: let the eldest pour/be served first; tapping two fingers on the table is a silent thank-you for tea refills in the south (Cantonese custom).
- Queueing and crowd flow at major sites is assertive - stay together, pick a regrouping point at every big attraction.

Booking timeline from Oct 9

When	Do
This week	Confirm mainland visas for all three; resolve the Oct 28 Southwest conflict; delete stale St Regis calendar entries; decide Macao-to-Hong Kong transfer (ferry vs bridge bus); book Peking duck (Oct 21) and Hong Kong dim sum.
Oct 12-13	Forbidden City tickets for Oct 20-22 (release 7 days ahead, 8 PM Beijing time); Huangshan entry + cable cars for Oct 24; Wuzhen Xizha tickets for Oct 25; Lingyin/Feilai Peak reservation for Oct 27.
Week of travel	Peak Tram + Sky Terrace combo for the clearest evening Oct 30-31 (buy flexible date if offered); re-check Air China H2GPV5, Xiamen Airlines Oct 28, and Cathay Pacific B88V3W in the airline apps.

Sources checked for this document

Forbidden City hours, pricing and 7-day booking: Palace Museum visitor guides via chinadiscovery.com and wanderinchina.com. Mutianyu costs and hours: beijingtourism.org. Huangshan entry and cable cars: thechinaguide.com and Trip.com scenic listings. Wuzhen Xizha hours and tickets: chinadiscovery.com. Lingyin Temple hours and fees: Trip.com attraction listings and visitor guides. Macao Ruins of St Paul's hours: macauhkairportbus.com. Hong Kong Peak Tram and Sky Terrace hours: thebettervacation.com. China World Summit Wing address and phone: visitbeijing.com.cn. Beijing October climate: historical daily tables via ruqintravel.com. Prices are the published 2026 guide prices checked Oct 2026 and can change - the booking apps at purchase time are authoritative.

Photos: Forbidden City, Mutianyu Great Wall, Huangshan, Wuzhen, West Lake (Leifeng Pagoda), Ruins of St Paul's Macao, and Hong Kong from Victoria Peak, sourced from public image search for this trip document. Itinerary facts (flights, hotels, confirmation codes, dates) are from your family's master schedule as recorded Oct 3-5, 2026, updated with your saved confirmations on Oct 11, 2026.